

VER. 26.1

Authenticity

Great Helms

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1. Implementation

The document has been created and approved by the General Assembly of 09.11.2024.
The document and its rules have been implemented since the 2025 season.

2. Definition

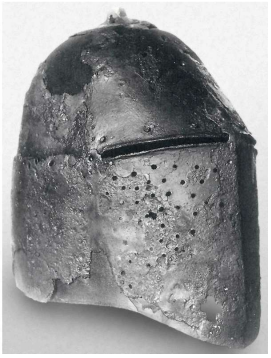
Great helms are a popular head defense formerly known as “Chapel de fer” from the 12th to the 14th centuries. Characterized by its cylindrical design and large size, it provided maximum protection for the face and neck. Often used as a secondary defense, it was worn over a maille coif, cervelliere, or bascinet.

During the 14th century, Great helms were used as a primary defense during battle. It was designed to be removed after the early engagements.

In the late 14th and during the 15th century, Great helms evolved to be suitable for tournaments only. Their latest version is called “Frogmouth” and is designed for jousting.

Great helms are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.

3. Historical Sources and Datation



Schweizerisches Landesmuseum - 1325/1350 - Switzerland



Germanisches National Museum - 1350 - Germany



Pembridge Helm, National Museum of Scotland - 1350/1375 - Scotland



Gerhard von Rieneck, Ederbach - 1382 - Germany



Sir Nicholas Hawkberk Helm - 1407 - England



“Frogmouth” helmet, The Art Institute of Chicago - 1490

4. Requirements

4.1. General Requirements

Reproductions must closely resemble the appearance and proportions of the sources.

Any metal part of the helmet must conform to the *“Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations”* document.

Any textile or leather part of the helmet must conform to the “*Textiles and Leather”* document.

4.2. Visor

The visor must not be too long or too short, it must respect the proportions of historical sources.

Breath holes should be round and consistently sized unless documented by an historical source.

Breath holes must not be so numerous that they compromise the helm’s structural integrity. It is acceptable to mirror breath holes to both sides.

4.3. Eye slots

Eye slots should resemble sources for the visor.

Eye slots should not exceed 25mm tall to prevent any injury.

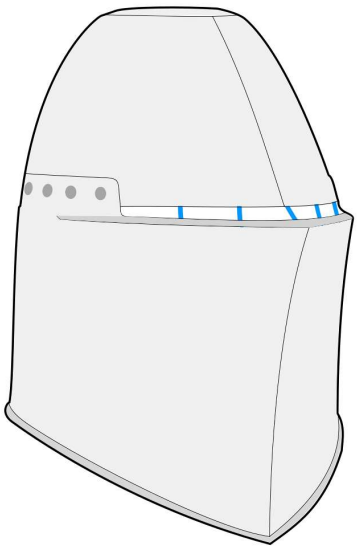
Externally riveted Eye bars must be based on documented historical examples.

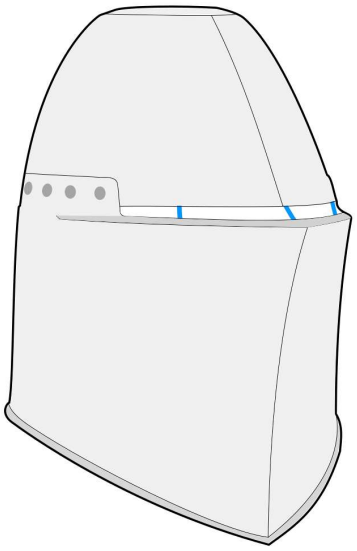
Great helms with two (2) Eye slots are permitted to add up to two (2) externally riveted Eye bars or safety Eye bars per Eye slot.

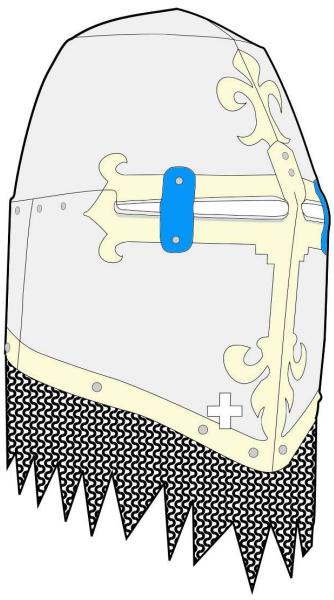
Great helms with a single Eye slot are allowed to add up to five (5) safety Eye bars: one (1) in the middle and two (2) on each side.

It is not possible to mix externally riveted Eye bars and safety Eye bars on the same helmet. Only one type of Eye bar is allowed. Integrated Eye bars are not allowed.

Eye bars must conform to the “*Eye bars*” document.







4.4. Aventails

Great helms must be worn with chainmail Aventail or scale Aventail. Fabric Aventails are not allowed.

Aventails must conform to the "*Aventails*" document.

Great helms can not have a suspension system made of vervelles and leather. Chainmail should be affixed to the interior of the helmet.

Any additional protective plates covering the cervical spine must be hidden under the Aventail.

4.5. Others

Great helms may be decorated in the spirit of medieval styles, such as an orle, torse, decorated Aventails (with copper/brass chainmail rings) coat of arms badges, etc.

Such decoration must be made in coherence with historical sources.

Using modern and/or offensive imagery and slogans is prohibited.

5. Examples of Approved Reproductions



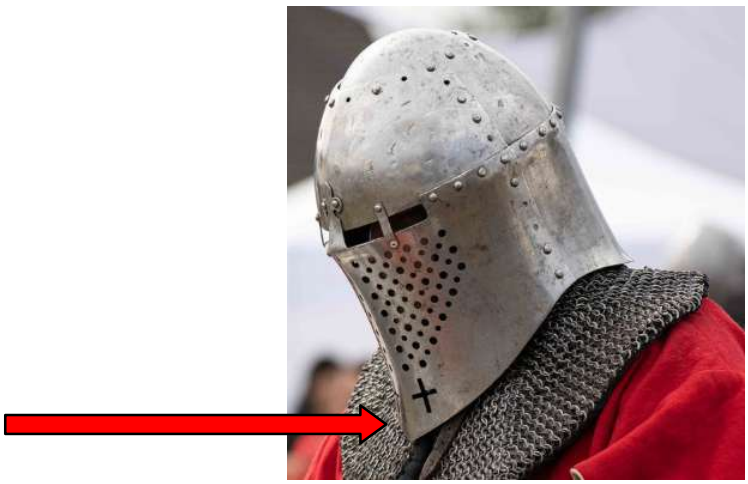
Picture from J. Gries ©



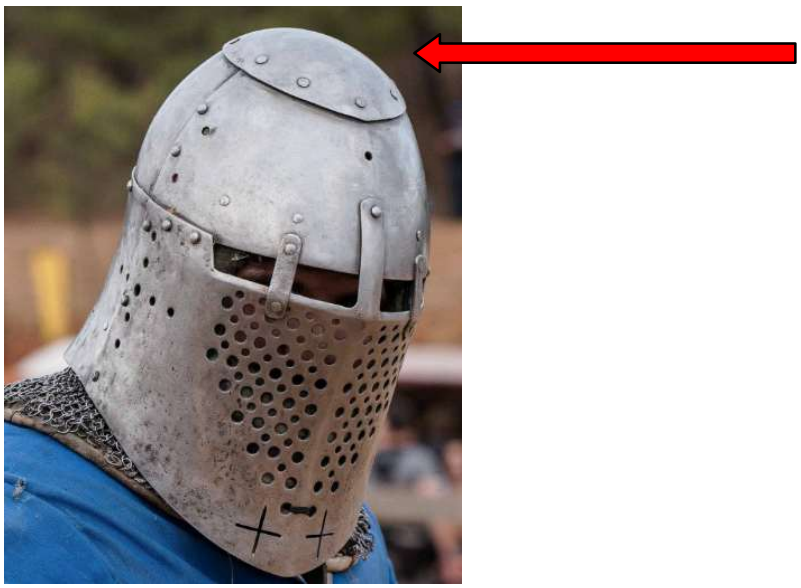
Picture from The Medieval Things ©

6. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Design of the bottom of the visor does not reproduce historical sources.



Design of the top of the helmet does not reproduce historical sources.



Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

7. Changelog

Below, we will keep track of all the changes made over the lifetime of this document. This way, all our members can see how the documents are changing over time.

January - 2026 (V. 26.1)
Formatting redone for consistency and readability. Except points listed below, no content changes.
Add: “1. Implementation” (and subsequent modification of all Title numbers in the document)
Clarification:
- In 4.2 Visor Requirements: “Breath holes should be round and consistently sized unless documented by an historical source.”

Add:
- In 4.3 Eye slots:
- “Externally riveted eye bars must be based on documented historical examples.”
- “Integrated eye bars are not allowed.”

Replace:
- In 4.3 Eye slots: “buhurt-optimized internal Eye bars” and “buhurt-optimized internal” by “safety Eye bars”

December-2024: -add
Document has been created